CHAPTER 7

GLOBALISATION

CHAPTER ESSENCE AT A GLANCE:
Examine the multidimensional phenomenon of globalisation across its technological catalysts, political consequences on state sovereignty, economic impacts on trade and inequality, cultural debates regarding homogenisation versus hybridity, and organised worldwide resistance led by bodies like the World Social Forum.

4 CORE PRINCIPLES TO UNDERSTAND FIRST

• **Multidimensional Concept of Globalisation:** Involves the accelerating, multi-directional flow of ideas, capital, commodities, and human beings across national boundaries, catalyzed fundamentally by revolutions in microelectronics and telecommunications.

• **Political Impact on State Capacity:** Leads to state minimalism where market forces dictate economic welfare, yet concurrently enhances state surveillance, intelligence, and administrative capability through information technologies.

• **Economic Consequences and Disparities:** Involves trade deregulation, expansion of multinational corporations, and capital mobility, creating economic expansion alongside rising socio-economic inequality and pressure on domestic safety nets.

• **Cultural Homogenisation and Heterogenisation:** Encompasses the fear of cultural westernization and uniform consumer culture (cultural imperialism) alongside the emergence of cultural hybridity where global elements combine with local cultural expressions.

ESSENTIAL CONSTITUTIONAL ARTICLES & THEORIES

$$\text{Globalisation Flow Matrix} \iff \{\text{Ideas Flow}, \quad \text{Capital Flow}, \quad \text{Commodities Flow}, \quad \text{People Flow}\}$$

Four Primary Vectors of Contemporary Global Interconnectedness

$$\text{State Capacity Dynamic} \iff \frac{\text{Retreat from Welfare (Minimalist State)}}{\text{Enhanced Administrative Surveillance via Information Technology}}$$

Dialectical Impact of Globalisation on the Modern Sovereign State

$$\text{Cultural Duality} \iff \text{Cultural Homogenisation (Westernization)} \longleftrightarrow \text{Cultural Heterogenisation (Hybridity)}$$

Cultural Dynamics between Standardization and Localization

$$\text{Anti-Globalisation Mobilisation} \iff \text{World Social Forum (Porto Alegre 2001)} \rightarrow \text{'Another World is Possible'}$$

Transnational Civil Society Resistance to Neoliberal Dominance

CRUCIAL EXAM PRECAUTIONS & VALUATION RUBRIC SECRETS

• **Alert:** Never define globalisation as purely an economic process; it is inherently multidimensional, encompassing political, economic, and cultural dimensions.

• **Alert:** Do not state that globalisation leads inevitably to the total demise of the sovereign state; states remain the central actors in international diplomacy and domestic security.

• **Alert:** Remember that cultural homogenisation is only one dimension of cultural globalisation; cultural heterogenisation and unique hybrid cultural forms are equally prominent.

HIGH-YIELD CENTUM QUESTIONS & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS

1. Define the concept of globalisation and identify the fundamental technological catalyst driving it. [Score: 2 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Definition:** A multidimensional process involving the rapid movement and interconnected flows of ideas, capital, commodities, and people across national borders. **[1 Mark]**

• **Technological Catalyst:** The microelectronic and telecommunications revolution, including the internet, computer microchips, and satellite networks. **[1 Mark]**

2. State two major economic consequences of international trade liberalization under globalisation. [Score: 2 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Increased Flow of Commodities and Capital:** Elimination of import tariffs and restrictions allows greater volumes of consumer goods, investments, and technologies to circulate freely. **[1 Mark]**

• **Unequal Distribution of Gains:** Disproportionate benefits accrue to wealthy corporations and skilled professionals, often exposing small domestic producers and farmers to harsh global competition. **[1 Mark]**

3. Examine how globalisation has altered the capacity and sovereignty of the modern state. [Score: 3 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Rise of the Minimalist State:** Governments withdraw from state-led economic welfare, allowing private market forces to determine socio-economic allocations. **[1 Mark]**

• **Retention of Core Functions:** The primacy of the state remains unchallenged in essential sovereign tasks like maintaining law and order, territorial defense, and foreign relations. **[1 Mark]**

• **Enhanced Surveillance Capabilities:** Advanced computing and information technology provide states with enhanced tools to monitor citizens, collect revenue, and enforce security. **[1 Mark]**

4. Distinguish between cultural homogenisation and cultural heterogenisation with suitable examples. [Score: 3 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Cultural Homogenisation:** The rise of a uniform global consumer culture, largely dominated by Western lifestyles, values, and branding (such as global fast-food chains and blue jeans), threatening indigenous cultures. **[1.5 Marks]**

• **Cultural Heterogenisation:** The process whereby global external cultural influences are modified and blended with local customs to produce unique hybrid cultural traditions (such as Indian khadi kurtas paired with jeans). **[1.5 Marks]**

5. What is the World Social Forum (WSF)? Outline its origins and main objectives. [Score: 3 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Origins:** A transnational coalition of human rights activists, environmentalists, labour unions, and youth founded in Porto Alegre, Brazil, in 2001. **[1 Mark]**

• **Primary Objective:** Provides a counter-platform to neoliberal corporate globalisation championed by bodies like the World Economic Forum, operating under the slogan 'Another World is Possible'. **[1 Mark]**

• **Global Gatherings:** Organizes mass international gatherings (including the 2004 Mumbai meeting) to mobilize global civil society against privatization, deregulation, and war. **[1 Mark]**

6. Discuss the multidimensional impact of globalisation on a developing nation like India. **[Score: 4 Marks]**

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Economic Growth and Inflow of Investment:** Triggered high GDP growth rates following the 1991 New Economic Policy, expanding the IT software sector, foreign direct investment, and consumer choices. **[1 Mark]**

• **Pressure on Agriculture and Public Welfare:** Exposed traditional farmers to fluctuating global agricultural prices and reduced government subsidies on fertilizer and power. **[1 Mark]**

• **Expansion of the Service Sector:** Generated employment opportunities in communications, business processing, banking, and pharmaceutical research for educated urban youth. **[1 Mark]**

• **Cultural Adaptations:** Encouraged modern cosmopolitan lifestyles alongside the vigorous assertion and celebration of traditional festivals, culinary heritage, and arts. **[1 Mark]**

7. Analyze the primary political and economic arguments advanced by critics against contemporary globalisation. **[Score: 3 Marks]**

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Left-Wing Critiques:** Argue that contemporary globalisation represents a new phase of global capitalism that enriches corporate oligarchs while impoverishing the working class, weakening public healthcare, education, and labor unions. **[1.5 Marks]**

• **Right-Wing Critiques:** Fear the erosion of national sovereignty, loss of indigenous cultural values and traditional family structures, and unregulated immigration threatening cultural identity. **[1.5 Marks]**